

Erik Katovich

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ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

University of Connecticut

Assistant Professor, Department of Agricultural and Resource Economics

2024–Present

University of Geneva

Postdoctoral Scholar, Institute of Economics and Econometrics

2022–2024

EDUCATION

University of Wisconsin-Madison

PhD in Agricultural and Applied Economics

2022

MS in Agricultural and Applied Economics

2020

University of Minnesota-Twin Cities

BS in Economics, *summa cum laude*

2015

RESEARCH FIELDS

Environmental and Resource Economics, Development Economics, Energy Economics, Political Economy

PUBLICATIONS

De Haro Lopez, Itzel and **Erik Katovich**, Explosive Diversification: Cartel Adaptation to Crackdowns in Mexico, 2026, *Journal of Economic Behavior and Organization*, Accepted

Katovich, Erik and Jonah Rexer, The Global Distribution of Critical Mining Impacts, 2026, *Oxford Review of Economic Policy*, Vol. 42, No. 1, pp. 170–192.

Katovich, Erik, Dominic Parker, and Steven Poelhekke, Timing is Everything: Labor Market Winners and Losers during Boom-Bust Cycles, 2026, *Journal of the Association of Environmental and Resource Economists*, Vol. 13, No. 1., pp. 229–260.

Katovich, Erik and Fanny Moffette, Does Local Politics Drive Tropical Land-Use Change? Property-Level Evidence from the Amazon, 2025, *The Economic Journal*, ueaf123, pp. 1–27.

Katovich, Erik, Winning and Losing the Resource Lottery: Governance after Uncertain Oil Discoveries, 2024, *Journal of Development Economics*, Vol. 166, No. 103204.

Katovich, Erik, Quantifying the Effects of Energy Infrastructure on Bird Populations and Biodiversity, 2024, *Environmental Science & Technology*, Vol. 58, No. 1, pp. 323–332.

Katovich, Erik and Alexandre Gori Maia, The Relation Between Labor Productivity and Wages in Brazil: A Sectoral Analysis, 2018, *Nova Economia*, Vol. 28, No. 1, pp. 7–38.

Smith, Pamela and **Erik Katovich**, Are GMO Policies “Trade Related”? Empirical Analysis of Latin America, 2017, *Applied Economic Perspectives and Policy*, Vol. 39, No. 2, pp. 286–312.

WORKING PAPERS

Solar Adoption as Agricultural Adaptation: Evidence from California's Central Valley (*with Cam McClure*) *Revised and Resubmitted at the Journal of Environmental Economics and Management*

Slaying Giants? Dynamic Impacts of Sanctions on Oil Companies, *Economists for Ukraine WP No. 27*

The Local Advantage: Firm Selection Under Weak Institutions (*with Utsoree Das and Jonah Rexer*)

Made in Brazil: Job Creation and Firm Performance Under a Local Content Requirement (*with Fabio Maciel*)

WORK IN PROGRESS

Digital Traceability for Deforestation-Free Supply Chains: Evidence from Cocoa Production in Ghana (*with George Akandinge, Francisco Alpízar, Mensah Cobbina, Utsoree Das, and Salvatore di Falco*) *Conditionally Accepted via Pre-Results Review at the Journal of Development Economics; RCT In-Progress*

Seeds of Influence: The Political Economy of Brazil's Soybean Boom (*with Ricardo Dahis*)

Human Capital and Spillovers Across the Mining Lifecycle (*with Steven Poelhekke and Fabio Maciel*)

Supply Response to Oil Production Taxes: Evidence from the US Royalty Relief Program (*with Julien Daubanes, Diego Cardoso, and Pritam Saha*)

Opting Out of a Boom: Long-Term Impacts of New York's Fracking Moratorium (*with Danlu Xu*)

GRANTS

USDA NIFA-AFRI (Award No. 2025-10030), Co-PI (\$591,419)	2026
USDA Hatch (\$20,000×2)	2025 & 2026
Structural Transformation and Economic Growth Small Research Grant (\$19,000)	2021
Doctoral Research Travel Grant, UW-Madison (\$1,500)	2021
Tinker Nave Latin American Studies Field Research Grant, UW-Madison (\$2,300×2)	2019 & 2021
IRIS Graduate Student Summer Fieldwork Award, UW-Madison (\$3,000)	2019
Technical Training Grant, São Paulo Research Association (FAPESP) (\$1,000)	2017
Fulbright Research Grant, Universidade Estadual de Campinas – Brazil (\$16,000)	2016
Undergraduate Research Opportunity Grant, U of MN (\$1,700×2)	2012 & 2014

AWARDS AND FELLOWSHIPS

Recognition for Teaching Excellence, UConn	2024, 2025, 2026
INFER Best PhD Paper Prize (<i>with Utsoree Das and Jonah Rexer</i>)	2025
Outstanding Doctoral Dissertation Award, UW-Madison AAE	2022
Bromley Prize for Best Dissertation Paper, UW-Madison AAE	2021
Early Excellence in Teaching Award, UW-Madison	2020
University Graduate Fellowship, UW-Madison (\$34,500×2)	2017 & 2020
Best Undergraduate Thesis, Minnesota Economic Association	2015
Gorence Endowed Scholarship in Economics, U of MN Economics	2013, 2014
Presidential Merit Scholarship, U of MN	2011-2015
National AP Scholar	2011
National Merit Scholar	2011

CONFERENCES AND INVITED PRESENTATIONS

(* indicates invited talk)

2026: UChicago Advances with Field Experiments, Yale/PEDL Firms, Trade, and Development Workshop, WCERE, ASSA

2025: UConn Economics*, Linnaean Society of New York*, NAERE, International Workshop on Empirical Methods in Energy Economics, UW-Madison Global Land Use and Environment Lab*

2024: Economics of a Livable Planet Authors' Workshop, Southeastern Workshop on Energy & Environmental Economics & Policy, Bird Protection Quebec*, Tinbergen Institute*, International Workshop in Energy & Resource Economics and Policy in Copenhagen, World Bank Land Conference, CESifo Conference on Energy & Climate Economics, University of Connecticut*, Wake Forest University*, University of Glasgow*, University of Wyoming*, ASSA

2023: Zurich Conference on Public Finance in Developing Countries, LACEA, EAERE, Bergen Economics of Energy and Environment Research Conference, SOLE, TRANSPATH-Wageningen

2022: Ipea Webinar, Geneva Trade and Development Workshop, STEG, NOVAFRICA, AERE, RIDGE Labor Workshop, PacDev, UW-Madison Global Land Use and Environment Lab*

2021: Universidade Federal Fluminense-PPGE*, SEA, Universidade de São Paulo-FEA*, NEUDC, LACEA, Sovereign Wealth Fund of Niterói*, Universidad de San Andrés-Economics*, AAEA, AERE, WEAI

2016-2020: Hoover Institution, ANPEC, COES-LSE

TEACHING AND ADVISING

(* indicates newly developed course)

Instructor, <i>Global Energy Transitions*</i> (PhD/Masters, UConn)	<i>Fall 2024-Present</i>
Instructor, <i>Energy Economics: Sustainable Transitions*</i> (Undergrad, UConn)	<i>Fall 2025-Present</i>
Instructor, <i>Graduate Research Seminar</i> (PhD/Masters, UConn)	<i>Fall 2025-Present</i>
Instructor, <i>Economics Methodology: Praxis and Practice*</i> (PhD/Masters, UConn)	<i>Fall 2024</i>
Instructor, <i>Introduction to Field Experiments*</i> (PhD, University of Geneva)	<i>Spring 2023</i>
TA, <i>Growth & Development of Nations in the Global Economy</i> (Undergrad, UW-Madison)	<i>Fall 2018</i>
—Received University-wide <i>Early Excellence in Teaching Award</i>	

Advising:

- PhD Committee: George Akandinge, Sandra Anyomi, James Palmer, Luis Palomino, MD Jaber Rana, Xudong Ren, Zahra Salehi, Tsurue Teshigawara, Leo Zhengxuan Wu, Danlu Xu
- Masters Capstone Advisor: John Daly, Cam McClure, Charlotte Rivard

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Short-Term Consultant	<i>August 2024-March 2025</i>
The World Bank Group	<i>Washington DC</i>

Research Assistant to Paul Dower, Emilia Tjernström, & Laura Schechter	<i>2019-2022</i>
Department of Agricultural and Applied Economics, UW Madison	<i>Madison, WI</i>

Visiting Researcher	<i>June-August 2019</i>
Institute of Economics, Federal University of Rio de Janeiro	<i>Rio de Janeiro, Brazil</i>

Impact Evaluation Fellow World Agroforestry Center (ICRAF)	June-August 2018 Nairobi, Kenya
Fulbright Research Fellow Center for Agricultural and Environmental Economics, Unicamp	February 2016-July 2017 Campinas, Brazil
Field Survey Coordinator Winrock International-Nepal	June-August 2014 Kathmandu, Nepal
Refugee and Immigrant Program Intern The Advocates for Human Rights	June-December 2013 Minneapolis, MN
Research Assistant to Pamela Smith Department of Applied Economics, University of Minnesota	June-December 2012 St. Paul, MN

SERVICE

Job Market Placement Director, UConn ARE	2026-2027
Conference Submission Reviewer, AAEA Annual Meeting	2026
Senior Faculty Hiring Committee, UConn ARE	2026
Graduate Admissions Committee, UConn ARE	2024-2027
Hatch Grant Review Panel, UConn CAHNR	2025
Seminar Organizing Committee, UConn ARE	2024-2027
External MS Thesis Reviewer, Universidad de San Andrés-Economics	2024
Scientific Committee, Rare Voices in Economics Conference, University of Geneva	2024
Mentor, Rare Voices in Economics Program, University of Geneva	2022-2024
Graduate Student Representative, UW-Madison AAE	2020-2021
Coordinator, Development and Political Economy Workshop, UW-Madison	2020-2021

Refereeing

Agricultural Economics, Applied Economics, Environment and Development Economics, Food Policy, Journal of Applied Ecology, Journal of the Agricultural and Applied Economics Association, Journal of the Association of Environmental and Resource Economists, Journal of Development Economics, Journal of Environment and Development, Journal of Environmental Economics and Management, Labour Economics, Land Economics, Latin American Research Review, Resource and Energy Economics, Quarterly Journal of Economics, Resources Policy

MEDIA APPEARANCES

VoxDev, [Agricultural Patronage: How Landholders Shape Politics in the Brazilian Amazon](#), May 2026
 Policy Implications, [Oil Sanctions: The Long Game Against Russia's Energy Sector](#), March 2026
 UConn Today, [Can Venezuela's Oil Bring Down Gas Prices? UConn Economist Explains](#), January 2026
 Connecticut Mirror, [In 2026 race for CT governor, electricity prices emerge as top issue](#), January 2026
 UConn Today, [How Political Influence Shapes Agricultural Expansion in the Amazon](#), January 2026
 Connecticut Mirror, [In Some CT Towns, Clouds Form Over New Solar Developments](#), October 2025
 Linnaean Society of New York, [Energy Infrastructure and Bird Biodiversity](#), September 2025
 Connecticut NPR, [The Pros and Cons of Going Nuclear](#), April 2025
 Connecticut Mirror, [Will Tariffs on Canadian Energy Impact CT Utility Bills?](#), March 2025
 Connecticut NPR, [Why Are Connecticut's Utility Bills So High?](#), February 2025

The Economist, *Wind Turbines are Friendlier to Birds than Oil-and-Gas Drilling*, January 2024
The Los Angeles Times, *Yes, Wind Turbines Kill Birds. But Fracking is Much Worse*, January 2024
Die Presse (Austria), *Wind Turbines Do Not Harm Birds*, January 2024
ETC (Sweden), *New Study: Wind Power Less Harmful to Birds than Fossil Energy*, January 2024
Le Temps (Switzerland), *Wind Turbines Are Less Dangerous for Birds than Oil*, February 2024
Tages Anzeiger (Switzerland), *Wind Turbines Are More Bird-Friendly than Oil and Gas*, January 2024
Courrier International (France), *Wind Turbines that Kill Birds: Perspective*, January 2024
Focus Online (Germany), *Wind Power and Birds: What really Endangers the Animals*, January 2024
BNNVARA (Netherlands), *Birds Shrug at Wind Turbines but Despise Oil Drilling*, January 2024
El Imparcial (Mexico), *Study Reveals Wind Turbines Friendlier to Birds than Oil and Gas*, January 2024
Enrique Dans (Blog), *The Science Shows that Wind Turbines do Not Harm Birdlife*, January 2024
VoxDev, *Unpredictable Oil Discoveries Fail to Deliver Local Development Benefits*, December 2023
Grist, *African Countries are Tapping Fossil Fuels. Why Aren't they Getting Rich?*, December 2022
World Bank Development Impact, *Governing the Rocky Beginnings of a Resource Boom*, November 2021

LANGUAGES AND TECHNOLOGY

Languages: English (native), Portuguese (fluent), Spanish (fluent), French (basic)

Computer Skills: Stata, R, L^AT_EX, SurveyCTO, Git

Last Update: September 2026